JOURNEY · STAGE-LABEL CONTRAST · #1702 · 2026-08-17

The stage ribbon takes the canvas it is painted on

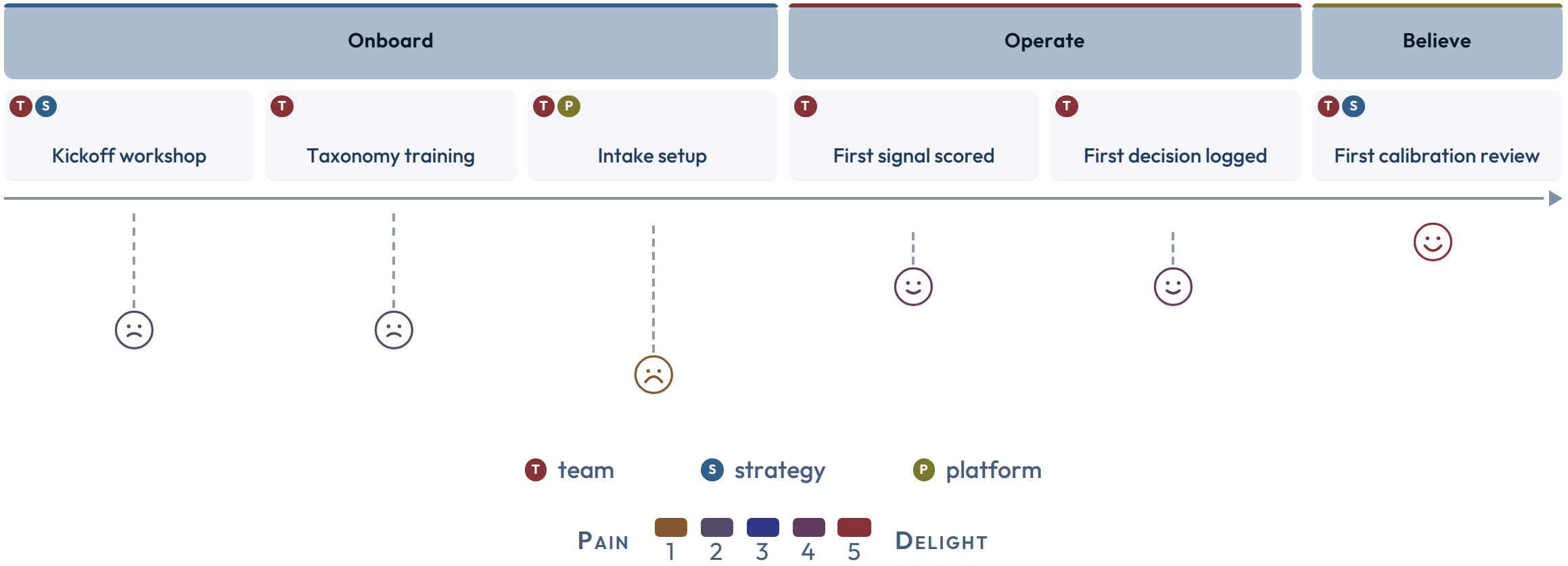
The section bar on every journey board was inked for a dark surface it only reaches in dark mode. Here is the fix, the four variants that carry it, and the gate that stops the class recurring.

DEFECT · #1702

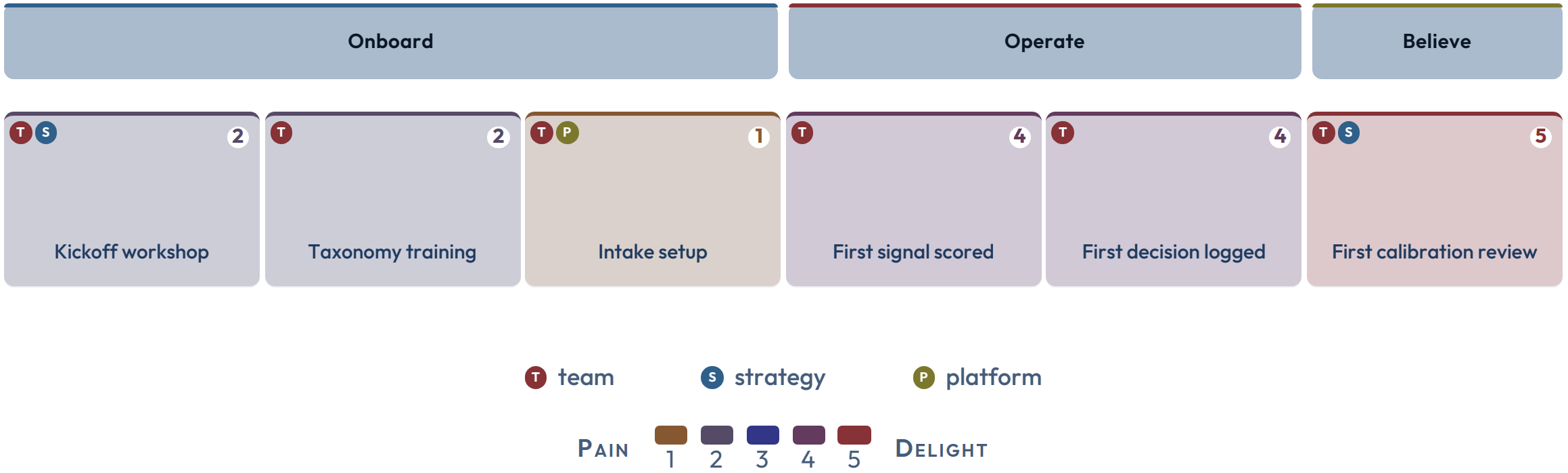
White labels on a surface that was never actually dark.

The stage bar fills `--bg-alt` deepened toward `--surface-inverse`, so it follows whatever canvas it sits on — dark in dark mode, a mid slate in light. Its ink was pinned to always-white on the strength of a comment claiming the fill was "always dark". Light mode shipped 1.87:1 against a 3:1 floor, in every palette.

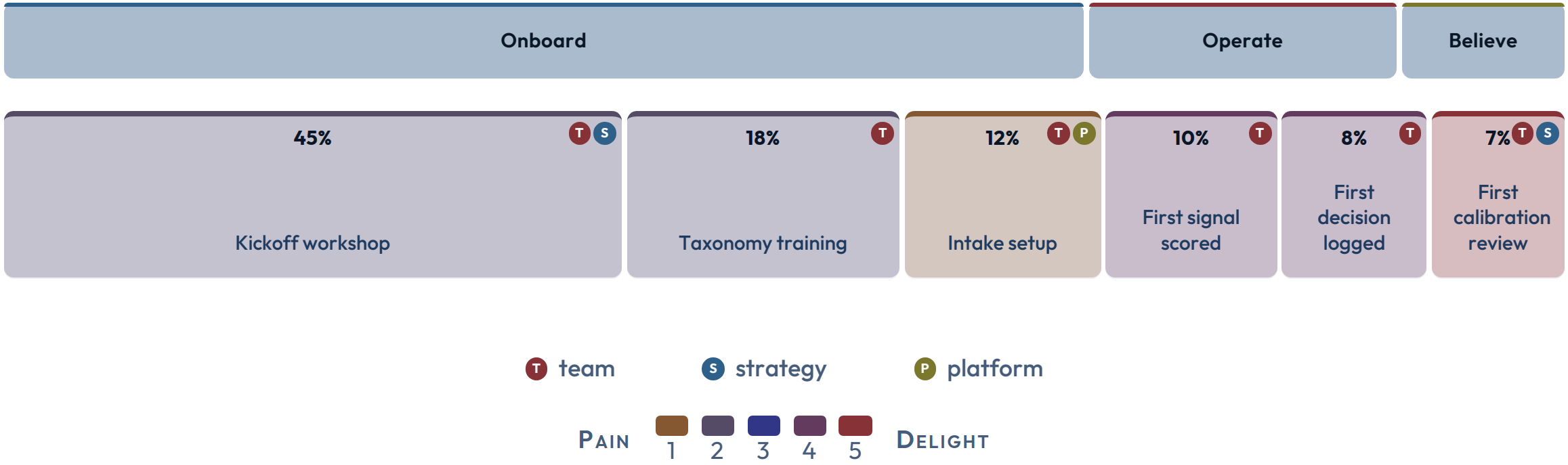
A team's first month runs from pain to belief, in that order, twice.



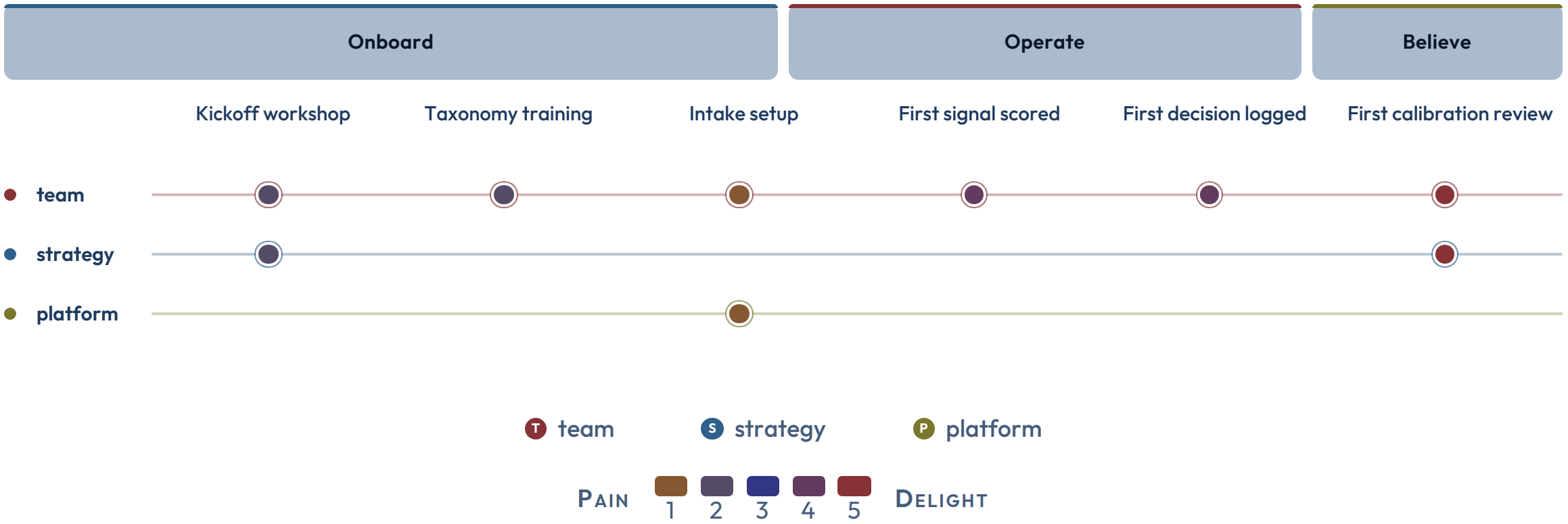
Tinting the chips surfaces the same month's emotional contour.



Chip width shows where the traffic in that month actually went.



Lanes show who was carrying each step, and where it handed off.



FIX · INK FOLLOWS THE FILL

The ink now follows the fill, and a gate now watches every gallery.

`--journey-stage-fg` becomes `--text-heading`, the ink the canvas already solves for: clear of 4.5:1 on all sixty-four palette and scheme pairs, worst 5.63:1. The mood legend lost an opacity wash that was costing it legibility for nothing. Behind both, `tools/check-slide-contrast.js` stops being on-demand — it now gates three rendered galleries in CI.

ONE TOOL ALREADY FOUND EVERY CONTRAST DEFECT WE HAVE SHIPPED. IT NEEDED WIRING TO CI, NOT MORE CLEVERNESS.

WHAT THIS CHANGE LEAVES BEHIND

A measurement that fires without being asked.